China. The Kushanas were known to the Chinese as the Yuezhi tribes of Central Asia. Central India, comprising present-day Andhra Pradesh, Telangana and Maharashtra, was ruled by the Satavahana dynasty.

The Three Kingdoms empire (220–280 CE): With the collapse of the Han empire, China once again fragmented into warring kingdoms. There were three major kingdoms that finally emerged as relatively stable entities. These were the Wei, Shu and Wu.

The Jin dynasty (266–420 CE): Their time continued to be a turbulent period for China.

The Kushan empire in India declined and the Gupta empire began to expand from the east. The Gupta empire ruled from 320 CE to 550 CE . The empire covered most of northern India. South of the Vindhyas were the Vakatakas, and further west the Rashtrakutas and the Kadambas (modern Karnataka).

The Northern and Southern dynasties (420–589 CE): This was a period of civil war and political turbulence in China. In northern China, the Northern Wei dynasty ruled from 386 CE to 535 CE , but then split into the Western Wei (535–557 CE) and Eastern Wei (534–550 CE). The Wei were from the Xianbei tribes from the northern steppes, chiefly Mongolia. The Northern Zhou ruled from 557 CE to 581 CE , and the Northern Qi from 550 CE to 577 CE . In southern China, the Liu Song ruled from 420 CE to 479 CE ; the Southern Qi from 479 CE to 502 CE , the Liang from 502 CE to 557 CE , and the Western Liang from 555 CE to 587 CE . The Chen ruled from 557 CE to 589 CE . The Chinese Buddhist monk Fa Xian visited India and South-East Asia between 399 CE and 412 CE .

The Guptas continued to rule in northern India.

The Sui dynasty (581–618 CE): Their rule partly overlapped with the reign of Harsha of Kannauj, who ruled northern India from 606 CE to 647 CE . Central and southern India were under the Chalukyas. The Chalukyan king Pulakesin-II defeated Harsha’s attack south of the Vindhyas.

The Tang dynasty (608–907 CE): They inaugurated a more outward-oriented and cosmopolitan era in Chinese history. It was a period of high culture. Like other Chinese dynasties, the Tang were threatened by the